PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Land Rover Range Rover L405

2012–2021 · L405

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Check every recall is closed**
  NHTSA lists keyless door-latch recalls for 2013–2016 trucks (doors may unlatch) and front-suspension knuckle recalls for 2014–2017 trucks (the upper knuckle joint can crack). AutoTrader.ca counted at least 19 safety recalls on this generation in Canada. Trucks that left the dealer network early are the most likely to have open campaigns. Run the VIN.

- [ ] **Be extra careful with pre-2015 trucks**
  PistonHeads' L405 guide says early cars had the most electrical and body problems. It advises a warranty, saying Land Rover's own cover for early cars costs around £1,400 a year after a free inspection. Panel fit on the rear doors, tailgate and bonnet is a known weak spot, and so are door seals.

- [ ] **Listen to the front end on a rough road**
  Coast and brake moderately over broken tarmac. Clunks or pops point to worn front track control arms or rear lower arms (around £700 fitted as a pair, per PistonHeads) — or, on 2014–2017 trucks, to the knuckle recall. AutoTrader.ca says not to take delivery of one with unusual front-end noise.

- [ ] **Watch the ride height overnight**
  Compressors fail and air springs split, and PistonHeads calls both 'known things.' Look for a corner that sags after standing, a compressor that runs constantly, or suspension faults on the dash. Check that every height mode works: access, normal and off-road.

- [ ] **Cold-start a 5.0 V8 yourself**
  A rattle lasting a second or two on a cold start is the classic sign of tired timing-chain guides and tensioners, particularly on 2010–2014 engines. Fault codes P0016–P0019 come later. A metallic rattle at idle can instead be the supercharger coupler or isolator. Look for coolant loss too: the plastic crossover pipes crack.

- [ ] **Ask how the diesel was serviced**
  TDV6/SDV6 crank-bearing failures are documented in Land Rover bulletin SSM71816 and in owner threads. Owners suspect oil sludging under long intervals and the wrong oil grade play a part. Ask for regular servicing with the correct oil. On the 4.4 SDV8, check for EGR faults and oily turbo breather pipes (up to £850 to replace).

- [ ] **Test the screens and switches**
  Infotainment freezes, dead cameras and Bluetooth faults are common and often fixed by software. If the head unit goes black or won't boot, assume an expensive repair until proved otherwise. Check the start/stop and steering-wheel buttons, the interior door releases, and the rotary gear selector, which can fail to rise.

- [ ] **Look at the wheels, and the transfer-case history**
  PistonHeads says the 22-inch wheels are soft and buckle on potholes, so check them for bends. AutoTrader.ca advises that any non-factory wheels come from a reputable brand and be rated for the truck's weight. Transfer-box and differential oil should be changed at around 30,000 miles, so ask for proof.

YEARS TO KNOW

2013–14	BEWARE	Early trucks. Specialist guides single out pre-2015 cars for the most electrical and body faults, and recalls cover door latches, airbags and the brake vacuum hose.
2018	SWEET SPOT	Facelift. Four-bar grille, new LED daytime running lights, thicker glass, and a dual-screen infotainment system where a second LCD replaces the climate knobs. Seat controls move to the doors. ReRev rates 2018–21 the most reliable L405s
2020	SWEET SPOT	3.0 Ingenium straight-six mild hybrid (P400) arrives. AutoTrader.ca recommends a 2020-or-newer truck with this engine if the budget allows.

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- [ ] **Seat SRS connector may disconnect**
  2013–2014 · NHTSA 13V-607
- [ ] **Brake vacuum hose routing**
  2013–2014 · NHTSA 15V-042
- [ ] **Occupant classification (passenger airbag)**
  2013–2015 · NHTSA 15V-093
- [ ] **Doors may unlatch**
  2013–2016 · NHTSA 15V-385
- [ ] **Keyless door latch (KV Latch)**
  2013–2016 · NHTSA 19V-392
- [ ] **Wheel lug nuts may crack**
  2015 · NHTSA 15V-092
- [ ] **Front upper knuckle may crack**
  2014–2017 · NHTSA 25V-514
- [ ] **Driver seat-belt retractor**
  2016–2017 · NHTSA 22V-219
- [ ] **Surround camera water ingress**
  2018–2022 · NHTSA 24V-023
- [ ] **Cam carrier oil channel**
  2020–2023 · NHTSA 23V-044

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **Pre- or post-facelift**
  Trucks from 2013 to 2017 have a three-bar grille, physical climate knobs and seat switches on the seat. From the 2018 model year they have a four-bar grille, new LED DRLs and twin touchscreens, and the seat controls are on the doors.
- [ ] **Wheelbase**
  The SWB is 2,922 mm (4,999 mm long). The LWB, from 2014, adds 200 mm, giving 3,122 mm (5,199 mm long), all of it in rear legroom.
- [ ] **US engines**
  5.0 supercharged V8 (510 PS, 525 PS from 2017); 3.0 supercharged V6 from 2014; Td6 diesel from 2016; P400e plug-in hybrid from the 2019 model year; 3.0 straight-six mild hybrid from 2020. The 4.4 SDV8 and the SDV6 Hybrid were never sold in the US.
- [ ] **Rear locker**
  Land Rover's owner guide lists separate fluid specs and fill volumes for the non-locking and electronic locking rear differentials. Check the build spec or the diff before you assume you have a locker.

- [ ] **SVAutobiography**
  The SVO-built flagship. The SVAutobiography Dynamic uses a 550 PS version of the supercharged 5.0. These trucks are worth far more than an HSE, so check the VIN-decoded build spec before paying SV money.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/range-rover/l405/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks